

git log options

History is only useful if you can read it

Scan, graph, then zoom

- Start with oneline for a short hash plus subject
- Add a count like minus five when you only need the recent tip
- Use graph with all to sketch how branches meet
- When you need detail, name-only lists paths touched

Browser lab

Digital Design and Verification Platform

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Tools

INTERACTIVE TOOL

git log options

Toggle --oneline, --graph, decorate, path filters, and more on a fixed chip-repo history — see the command line and output update together.

Starter example: Default git log --decorate on main after merging feature/alu-mul. Try --oneline --graph and path rtl/alu.v.

Load starter example

Challenges 0 / 22 cleared

Quiz: oneline: Flag for short hash + subject per line? Answer: --oneline

Answer

Show hint

Check

Next

Idle

Quiz: oneline

Quiz: graph

Quiz: decorate

Enable oneline

Oneline+graph

Starter count

Path alu.v

alu.v count

Quiz: --

Author Ada

Ada count

Grep alu

Limit -n 2

Quiz: -n

See HEAD

Enable stat

docs path

Quiz: combo

Bea + tb

Empty result

Tag decorate

Merge tip

Options

History: init → wire alu → tb → docs||mul branch → merge on main.

default

oneline+graph

alu.v only

author Ada -n3

grep alu + stat

☐ --oneline
short hash + subject

☐ --graph
ASCII commit graph

☒ --decorate
show refs / tags

☐ --all
all refs (lab: same walk)

Output

git log --decorate

6 commits shown

```
commit a8f3c21 (HEAD, main)
Merge: b2e91d0 c4d10aa
Author: Ada
Date: 2026-07-18
```

git log lab starter

Real Git practice

```
wsl - module05-git-log-lab/examples/log_options

# Track A - real Unix

# real shell session (Track A)

# practice repo: /tmp/git-log-8PVpik

$ git log --oneline
077c3c7 Add README
1001c0b Expand notes
6e3b594 Add notes

$ git log --oneline -3
077c3c7 Add README
1001c0b Expand notes
6e3b594 Add notes

$ git log --oneline --graph --all
* 077c3c7 Add README
* 1001c0b Expand notes
* 6e3b594 Add notes

$ git log --name-only -1
commit 077c3c7a5672984c349b44cd68af75d3bda6dd13
Author: Demo <demo@local>
Date:   Mon Jul 20 14:14:38 2026 +0800

    Add README

README.md

$ git log --oneline -- notes.md
1001c0b Expand notes
6e3b594 Add notes
```

Real shell — oneline, graph, and path filters

Real Git practice — try these

```
# git log --oneline — short hash plus subject for each commit  
git log --oneline
```

```
# git log --oneline -3 — only the last three commits  
git log --oneline -3
```

```
# git log --oneline --graph --all — compact history with branch shape  
git log --oneline --graph --all
```

```
# git log --name-only -1 — paths touched by the latest commit  
git log --name-only -1
```

```
# git log --oneline -- notes.md — commits that touched this path  
git log --oneline -- notes.md
```

Pitfalls to watch

- Do not confuse a path filter, two dashes then a path, with a branch name
- Remember that graph without oneline can be noisy on a long history
- And remember

Your turn

- Complete the checklist for at least one track, preferably both
- In the browser, load the starter and clear a few option challenges
- On real Git, practice oneline, a limit, graph, and a path filter in your practice tree
- When you are ready, take the short quiz, then continue to the next module on safe undo